

PROJECT CHARTER

Fusion Flavours: A Recipe Book for Cultural Exploration

Course: Project Life Cycle Management and Communications

Program: Business Analytics

School of Business | St. Lawrence College

Completed as a two-person academic team project

1. General Project Information

Item	Details
Project Name	Fusion Flavours: A Recipe Book for Cultural Exploration
Project Team	Two-person student team
Primary Responsibilities	Graphic design and layout; research and content writing; recipe development; project documentation
Project Sponsor / Instructor	Course instructor
Estimated Budget	\$300 (fictional academic estimate)
Expected Start Date	June 20, 2024
Expected Completion Date	August 3, 2024
Final Deliverables	Project charter, Gantt chart, digital cookbook, and feedback survey

2. Project Overview

Context

The idea for a student-focused cookbook originated from an awareness of the challenges many college students face, including limited cooking knowledge, restricted budgets, and time constraints. Cooking at home can be both economical and health-conscious, while the cultural diversity of the student population creates an opportunity for shared learning through food. This project aimed to help students prepare simple, affordable, and satisfying meals while also encouraging cultural exploration through recipes from different parts of the world.

Problem / Opportunity Statement

College students may struggle to prepare affordable, nutritious, and culturally varied meals because of limited time, limited cooking experience, and budget constraints. A digital cookbook offers an opportunity to provide easy-to-follow recipes, vegetarian alternatives, and cultural background information in one accessible resource. The project also creates an opportunity to promote cultural awareness and encourage students to connect through shared food experiences.

Benefits

The student-focused cookbook was intended to improve students' access to practical meal ideas while supporting cultural learning and engagement.

- Provide affordable and beginner-friendly recipe ideas for students.
- Support healthier home cooking through simple ingredients and clear instructions.
- Increase students' confidence in preparing meals independently.
- Introduce readers to cuisines and food traditions from different cultures.
- Offer vegetarian alternatives to broaden accessibility.
- Encourage cultural appreciation and community connection through food.
- Enable easy and low-cost distribution through a digital format.

Within Scope

- Development of a collection of simple, budget-conscious recipes suitable for college and university students.
- Inclusion of recipes representing multiple cultures, vegetarian alternatives, and fusion recipes.
- Design and layout of the digital cookbook using Canva.
- Inclusion of cultural background information and easy-to-follow cooking instructions.
- Creation of a digital link for classroom distribution.
- Creation of a Google Forms survey to collect feedback from readers.
- Preparation of a project charter, Gantt chart, timeline, stakeholder analysis, and risk plan.

Out of Scope

- Production and distribution of physical copies of the cookbook.
- Detailed professional nutritional analysis of each recipe.
- Customization for individual medical or dietary requirements.
- Advanced cooking techniques or gourmet-level instruction.
- Commercial endorsements or brand sponsorships.
- Long-term tracking of user behaviour beyond the initial feedback exercise.
- Translation into multiple languages.
- Formal recipe testing or food-safety certification.

3. Stakeholder Analysis

Stakeholder	Interest	Concerns	Contribution
Students	Access to affordable, culturally diverse, easy-to-follow recipes and cultural information.	Affordability, ease of preparation, ingredient availability, clarity, and variety.	Review the cookbook and provide feedback.
Project Team	Successful completion of all academic and project deliverables.	Time, coordination, content quality, consistency, and technical access.	Research, writing, scheduling, design, documentation, and distribution.
Instructor	Demonstration of project lifecycle and communication concepts.	Completeness, feasibility, quality of documentation, and delivery.	Academic guidance, review, and evaluation.
Recipe Contributors / Sources	Accurate and respectful representation of recipes and cultural traditions.	Authenticity, attribution, clarity, and intellectual property considerations.	Recipe ideas, methods, and cultural context.
College Community	Cultural learning, student engagement, and accessible resources.	Relevance, accessibility, and usefulness to students.	Participation, sharing, and feedback.

4. Solution Feasibility Study

The project compared two delivery options:

- Option 1: Printed cookbook
- Option 2: Digital cookbook

Evaluation Criterion	Option 1: Printed Cookbook	Option 2: Digital Cookbook	Reasoning
Cost	1/5	5/5	Printing requires paper, ink, binding, and distribution costs, while digital sharing has minimal cost.
Flexibility	1/5	5/5	Printed content is difficult to update; digital content can be revised and redistributed easily.
Customization	2/5	5/5	A digital version can be reorganized, expanded, or tailored more easily than a printed version.
Scalability	2/5	5/5	Additional readers can access the digital version without producing more copies.
Time to Distribute	2/5	5/5	A digital link can be distributed immediately after the cookbook is completed.

Overall Assessment

The printed option received lower scores because of higher costs, limited flexibility, and the need to produce additional copies for wider distribution. The digital option received higher scores across all criteria because it was inexpensive, easy to update, scalable, and quick to distribute.

Based on this assessment, the digital cookbook was selected as the preferred option.

5. Detailed List of Deliverables

Deliverable Category	Target Completion	Planned Deliverable	Completion Status
Recipe Collection and Content Research	July 7, 2024	Gather recipes from different cultures and prepare clear cooking directions.	Completed through research and curation; recipes were not formally tested.
Design and Layout	July 22, 2024	Create the cookbook introduction, cultural notes, recipe pages, and visual layout.	Completed in Canva.
Fusion Recipe Development	July 2024	Create recipes that combine elements from different cuisines.	Completed.
Digital Distribution	July 25, 2024	Provide students with access to the digital cookbook through an online link.	Completed in the classroom setting.
Monitoring and Evaluation	August 2024	Collect user feedback and review the final deliverable.	Completed using Google Forms; 22 responses were collected.
Promotional Materials	July 2024	Create posters, flyers, or email newsletters.	Not completed and not required for the final classroom delivery.

6. Cost Estimates

The following budget was a fictional academic estimate used to demonstrate project cost planning. It does not represent confirmed actual spending.

Category	Cost Estimate	Percentage of Total Budget
Recipe-related materials and content preparation	\$200	66.7%
Miscellaneous	\$100	33.3%
Total	\$300	100%

7. Timeline and Milestones

Date / Period	Milestone	Status
June 2024	Formal project initiation, topic selection, team coordination, and definition of project objectives and scope.	Completed
June 2024	Research and collection of recipes and cultural background information.	Completed
June-July 2024	Preparation of the project charter, stakeholder analysis, risk plan, and Gantt chart.	Completed
July 2024	Development of the Canva layout and organization of traditional, vegetarian, and fusion recipes.	Completed
July 2024	Final review and preparation of the digital cookbook.	Completed
July-August 2024	Distribution of the cookbook to classmates and collection of feedback through Google Forms.	Completed
August 2024	Final submission of the project charter, Gantt chart, and cookbook.	Completed

8. Risks and Dependencies

Risk / Dependency	Context	Mitigation Strategy
Delays in recipe collection	Difficulty obtaining a varied selection of recipes and cultural information.	Begin research early, use multiple sources, and seek suggestions from friends and classmates.
Quality and consistency of content	Recipe instructions and cultural descriptions may vary in detail and tone.	Use a consistent content structure and complete a final editing review.
Difficulty creating meaningful fusion recipes	Some combinations may not be practical or culturally appropriate.	Research the original dishes carefully and select combinations with compatible ingredients and preparation methods.
Design and layout challenges	Creating a professional and consistent cookbook within limited time and resources.	Use a Canva template, apply consistent typography and page structure, and allow time for revisions.
Technology and file-sharing issues	Readers may have difficulty opening the link or accessing the final file.	Test the link before distribution and keep backup copies in multiple formats.
Resource availability	Access to design tools, recipe information, and project files may be limited.	Plan resource needs early and maintain organized backup copies.
Copyright and attribution	Online recipes and images may require credit before public publication.	Add recipe sources, image credits, and an academic-use disclaimer before GitHub publication.

9. Assumptions and Validation Strategies

Assumption	Validation Strategy
Students would be interested in culturally diverse recipes.	Distribute the cookbook in class and ask readers about cultural learning and overall interest.
A digital format would be easier and less costly to distribute.	Share the cookbook using an online link and confirm that classmates can access it.
The recipes and layout would be understandable to students.	Use a feedback form to ask about clarity, design, and overall experience.
Vegetarian alternatives would increase relevance for a broader audience.	Include vegetarian versions and invite comments on recipe variety.
The project schedule could be managed within the academic term.	Track activities and deadlines using the Gantt chart.

10. Final Outcome

The project resulted in a completed digital cookbook designed in Canva. The cookbook included traditional recipes, vegetarian alternatives, fusion recipes, cultural background information, and a feedback link. It was distributed to classmates, and feedback was collected through Google Forms. The project received an A+ grade.

11. Tools Used

Tool	Use in the Project
Canva	Cookbook design, layout, visual presentation, and final digital deliverable
Google Sheets / Microsoft Excel	Gantt chart, schedule tracking, and project-planning tables
Google Forms	Feedback survey and response collection
Google Docs / Microsoft Word	Project charter drafting, editing, and formatting
PowerPoint	Presentation support

12. Individual Contribution

The project was completed collaboratively by a two-person team. Contributions are outlined below.

Team Member A (Sonal Upasani)

- Preparing and formatting the final project charter.
- Developing the stakeholder analysis.
- Preparing the risk and mitigation section.
- Maintaining and updating the Gantt chart.
- Leading the Canva-based development and assembly of the final cookbook.
- Supporting timeline planning, recipe research, classroom distribution, and feedback collection.

Team Member B

- Conducting recipe research and gathering cultural background information for all dishes.
- Writing cultural descriptions and recipe content for traditional, vegetarian, and fusion sections.
- Contributing to the development and selection of fusion recipe combinations.
- Supporting the feasibility study, assumptions, and project overview documentation.
- Assisting with classroom distribution, feedback survey design, and final review.